

The Indie Builder's Journey

What 1,000 verified startups on TrustMRR teach us about where the market is moving, what's actually making money, and how to stop guessing.

Act I: The Gold Rush of 2026

Every builder wants to know: what's working right now?

Where Builders Are Placing Their Bets

AI Workflows & Content Wrappers

The data reveals a massive wave of micro-SaaS projects tackling automated content generation, programmatic SEO, and AI workflow automation.

B2C Apps vs. B2B Workflows

While consumer mobile apps chase high-volume downloads via RevenueCat, serious recurring revenue (\$10k+ MRR) overwhelmingly flows through B2B Stripe APIs.

The Pipes Behind the Profit

- Stripe is the undeniable heavyweight, powering over 85% of high-earning indie SaaS checkouts.
- RevenueCat quietly captures the explosive mobile subscription economy for consumer utilities and apps.
- Alternative merchant-of-record tools (Paddle, Lemon Squeezy) solve global tax nightmares effortlessly.
- The stack matters less than solving real friction—but picking the right rails saves months of engineering.



Act II: The Reality Check

Looking past the hype to examine actual financial traction.

The Power Law of Micro-SaaS

3.5M+

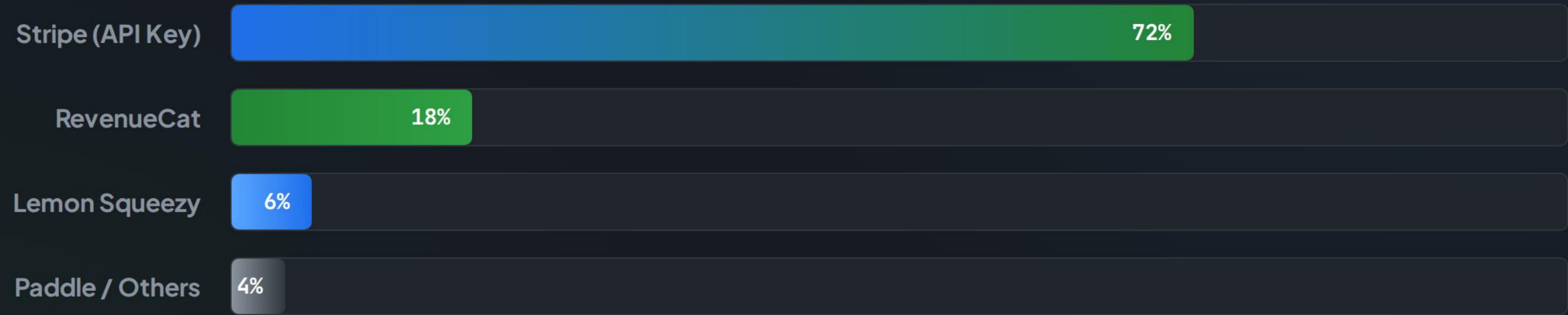
Top Monthly Revenue (\$)

The Pareto Rule in Full Effect

A few category-defining outliers command millions in monthly revenue, while the majority of indie projects hover between \$0 and \$1,000 MRR.

The secret isn't luck—it's targeting high-intent B2B pain points instead of building crowded consumer novelty apps.

Checkout Infrastructure Breakdown



Stripe completely dominates B2B SaaS checkouts, while RevenueCat is the undisputed leader for mobile app store monetization.

Act III: The Compass

How TrustMRR transforms raw dataset signals into a builder's playbook.

How TrustMRR Guides Your Build



Validate Before Coding

Inspect verified MRR and churn figures to discover which categories actually reach product-market fit without burning out.



Benchmark Pricing

Peek behind the curtain at competitor pricing models, tiered feature gates, and payment gateways across live indie projects.



Plan Your Exit

Understand revenue multiples, valuation expectations, and market demand when you're ready to acquire or exit.

The Builder's Action Plan

- ✔ **Solve Proven Problems:** Build around workflows where verified businesses are already spending money on Stripe or RevenueCat.
- ➔ **Prioritize Distribution:** Focus early on programmatic SEO and community loops rather than endless feature bloat.
- ★ **Embrace Transparency:** Use verified metrics to build instant social proof, earn trust, and accelerate user acquisition.

Time to Build

The indie hacker ecosystem has moved past simple novelty apps. Successful builders combine real data intelligence with rapid, agile execution.

Stop guessing what market wants. Let verified category performance guide your next shipping cycle and turn your side project into sustainable recurring revenue.



What Will You Ship Next?

Let's analyze the data and build something remarkable together.

trustmrr.com | build@indiesaaS.io

Image Sources

600 × 400

http://googleusercontent.com/image_collection/image_retrieval/10727464067252901929

Source: www.geckoboard.com

600 × 400

http://googleusercontent.com/image_collection/image_retrieval/7191069885038502860

Source: www.vecteezy.com

Image Sources

600 × 400

<https://www.geckoboard.com/uploads/early-stage-startup-dashboard-example.png>

Source: www.geckoboard.com

600 × 400

https://static.vecteezy.com/system/resources/thumbnails/058/000/566/small_2x/male-developer-entering-binary-data-on-terminal-panel-while-writing-html-code-sftware-engineer-working-on-troubleshooting-with-programming-language-internet-and-server-security-camera-b-video.jpg

Source: www.vecteezy.com

Image Sources



<https://www.geckoboard.com/uploads/early-stage-startup-dashboard-example.png>

Source: www.geckoboard.com



https://static.vecteezy.com/system/resources/thumbnails/058/000/566/small_2x/male-developer-entering-binary-data-on-terminal-panel-while-writing-html-code-sftware-engineer-working-on-troubleshooting-with-programming-language-internet-and-server-security-camera-b-video.jpg

Source: www.vecteezy.com